

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Functional/substantive definitions, Buddhism, Jainism, Mīmāṃsā, Sāṃkhya, agnosticism and direct PYQ routes are CORE PAPER II.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Boundary control, objections, comparisons and graded verdicts are CORE ANSWER.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Modern religious naturalism is SUPPORTING when it clarifies, not replaces, Indian traditions.

ANSWER LINE: [FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

02

Contemporary scholarly anchor — [SUPPORTING]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Fact: Recent 2025–2026 scholarship and reviews continue to discuss religious naturalism as an attempt to retain awe, value, ritual and community within a naturalistic worldview.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: This strengthens the conceptual question whether supernatural belief is necessary for religion, but it does not displace the syllabus's primary evidence: Buddhism, Jainism, Mīmāṃsā and Sāṃkhya.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Inference: This strengthens the conceptual question whether supernatural belief is necessary for religion, but it does not displace the syllabus's primary evidence: Buddhism, Jainism, Mīmāṃsā and Sāṃkhya.

ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: Recent 2025–2026 scholarship and reviews continue to discuss religious naturalism as an attempt to retain awe, value, ritual and community within a naturalistic worldview.

03

Visual gateway — define before judging

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Master verdict: A personal creator is not necessary for religion, but some disciplined orientation to ultimacy, transformation, community and soteriology is needed to prevent the category from becoming empty.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (Recommended opening definition): Religion is a disciplined orientation to an ultimate or sacred order through doctrine, practice, community and transformation; belief in a personal creator is not a necessary condition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Agnosticism suspends judgement about God's existence or knowability; unlike atheism, it withholds assent rather than asserting denial.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Master verdict: A personal creator is not necessary for religion, but some disciplined orientation to ultimacy, transformation, community and soteriology is needed to prevent the category from becoming empty.

ANSWER LINE: Buddhism is a complete non-creator religion because dependent origination explains suffering, the path disciplines life, the Saṅgha (Buddhist monastic and practitioner community) sustains practice and nirvāṇa (liberation from suffering) supplies the final goal.